met who made her feel wicked by comparison. Apparently she didn't mind feeling wicked.

We then went down to Greenwich Village to see some arty movie called The Forgotten Village and after that we had a midnight snack.

Finally I said, "I can't stay out much later than this because I have to help with the paper delivery tomorrow morning at my father's candy store."

On a later occasion, Gertrude said that that had impressed her

mightily. I had apparently made no attempt to pretty up the situation but had admitted having a father who owned a candy store. Nor did I pretend I did something more important than fool around with newspapers. It seemed very honest.

Actually, it should have seemed very stupid. If it had ever occurred to me that I might have gained ground by lying, I might very well have tried to. It just didn't occur to me, and it never does, even to this day. With all the years I now own and all the experience I now possess, I still somehow possess a foolish lack of sophistication in such things.

But I did take her home, even though it turned out she lived in Brighton Beach at the far end of Brooklyn, and I didn't get home till 4:00 a.m. (My father didn't mind what time I got home, actually, as long as I was in the store at 7:00 a.m. to help with the papers—and, of course, I was.)

3

That blind date on Valentine's day was exhilarating, but it was expensive, as I had feared. The whole thing had cost me $2.50, and although Joe, exuberant over the apparent success of the date spoke of another date on Thursday, I was dubious. Where was I to get the money? 1

Yet when Thursday, February 19, came, I was there, too. Expensive or not, I wanted to see Gertrude again. I managed to get lost and showed up fifteen minutes late at the trysting place, but after that all went well. At a radio station we attended a discussion called "Brotherhood of Man: Is It Fact or Fiction?," which was free, and in which someone quoted a bit of doggerel I have remembered ever since:

The rain, it raineth every day Upon the just and unjust fella. But more upon the just y because The unjust has the just's umbrella.